

Sales & Operations Optimization Report – Cake Story

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Tools: Microsoft Excel | Power Query | DAX (Power Pivot) | Pivot Tables

1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes \$20.5M in sales data for Cake Story with the objective of identifying revenue risks, return drivers, and operational inefficiencies. Using Excel-based analytics, the study uncovers the root causes behind \$1.6M in returns and provides targeted, data-driven recommendations.

2. Data Engineering & Transformation (ETL)

- Data cleaning and normalization using Power Query.
- Feature engineering for product and employee segmentation.
- DAX measures created for Total Sales and Return Rate calculations.

3. Employee Performance Analysis

Employee	Total Sales	Return Rate	Performance Insight
Ahmed Ali	\$7.31M	2%	Benchmark performer with excellent quality control
Morsy Abdelwahab	\$7.09M	7%	Operational handling issues detected
Samy Abo Aladi	\$4.77M	16%	High sales with critical return risk
Mohsen Alaa	\$1.37M	13%	Low volume with high operational risk

4. Product-Level Diagnostic Insights

- Cupcake, Cheesecake, and Ice Cream show consistently high return rates across multiple employees.
- Indicates manufacturing, packaging, or shelf-life defects rather than individual handling issues.
- Honey Kunafa shows stable performance when handled correctly, proving product viability.

5. Revenue Concentration & Seasonality

- 10 stores generate 51% of total revenue (concentration risk).
- 10 products account for 93% of sales volume.
- Sales peak in November driven by a 15% discount, followed by a sharp Q1 decline.

6. Strategic Recommendations

1. Standardize employee training using Ahmed Ali as a benchmark.

2. Immediate retraining for high-risk employees before scaling sales.
3. Review or redesign high-loss products (Cupcake, Cheesecake, Ice Cream).
4. Expand marketing efforts to underperforming stores.
5. Launch Q1 retention campaigns to stabilize post-peak revenue.

7. Conclusion

This project demonstrates how Excel, Power Query, and DAX can be leveraged to move beyond reporting toward root-cause discovery. The findings enable Cake Story to take precise corrective actions, protect revenue streams, and improve operational efficiency.

Portfolio: Menna Mohamed *Data Analyst | Business Intelligence Specialist*